

## 42 Want a stylus?

The stylus is not just an archaic touch-screen tool that's still being pushed for use in modern devices. The stylus, while mostly useless on current phones, given the finger-friendly UI, is still a popular input device, particularly for large-screen phones. It offers greater precision, but unless you need it, it serves no functional purpose. Also, make sure that the phone you buy has some mechanism to store the stylus when not in use.



## 43 3G USB dongle supports

A common mistake people make while picking up a Wi-Fi only tablet is to check for a 3G USB dongle support. Most Android tablets support the popular 3G dongles available in India such as those from Reliance, Tata Photon, Huawei and more. However, there are some tablets that only support a particular 3G USB dongle. You can check the box or the manufacturers website for these details.



## 44 The right resolution

Picking the right resolution for a laptop is tricky business. A lower resolution screen means less load on the GPU and improved battery life, but the trade-off is a (comparatively) blurry display. For smaller screens, below 13", this is fine. The higher-resolution is best on larger screens.



## 45 Expensive lens= better images

Just because you shelled out upwards of ₹80,000 on a lens doesn't mean that it's the most awesome lens in the world. Choose your lens wisely. Read reviews, consult a few experienced people if possible and more importantly, find a way to try a lens before buying it. Also, remember that a lens that costs ₹6,000 (The Canon EF 50mm f/1.8) for example, offers better quality than most lenses retailing at more than triple the price. Disregarding all the above however, remember that a lens doesn't determine your ability to take great pictures.



## 46 Dealer vs. manufacturer's warranty

Many of those lower-priced devices that you may find online will be backed by a seller/dealer warranty. This type of warranty is useless unless you know from experience that the seller is extremely reliable.

Such phones (with the seller warranty) are a risk from the moment you buy them and all your servicing needs are dependant on a guy who you might never see ever again. Not all dealer warranty is bad, and also, whether you need the warranty or not depends on the discount you get. Massive discounts might be worth losing the warranty over. You're the best judge.



## 47 No amount of sorcery can make a laptop sound as good as a home theatre, don't believe those fancy stickers

Laptops claim "Dolby" surround sound, some of them even manage to integrate "woofers" underneath the chassis. All that razzmatazz seldom translates to good quality sound, though, honestly speaking, Dolby certified speakers are generally better than the average speakers.



## 48 Gorilla glass vs. scratch guards

Many manufacturers pass off their screens as "scratch-resistant" but remember, Gorilla glass is gorilla glass and many manufacturers skimp out on this (including such big names as Sony) and you won't really be aware of the exact certification of the supposed scratch-resistant screen that you've got. In such a situation, a good scratch guard is a life-saver. Stock scratch-guards are usually bad and it's best to get a reputed one for your screen.



## 49 Chargers and cables

This is a very common mistake that people make, believing that any charger will do for their device. Most of the time, tablets are provided with custom chargers due to the higher capacities of their batteries. You can't just mix and match and assume that any charger is fine for your device. The power requirements will defer from device to device and you'd better be aware of what those requirements are. Slapping a 2.1A charger on a 7" tablet might effectively kill the device.



## 50 HD, Full HD, Ultra HD, Ultra Mega HOLYHELL HD Video

In our journey through various big store chains, many salesmen told us that some cameras recorded HD video and some did Full HD. When asked what the difference was, we were told that HD meant 720p while Full HD meant 1080p. You can argue about the merits of one over the other but just know this, forget the nonsense that's spewing from that salesman, whip out your phone and Google the specs.

